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United States Patent	12383782
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 12, 2025
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Exercise sled

Abstract

An exercise sled (10) for performing a core strengthening exercise routine has a load bearing body (12) with a bottom (14) configured to slide on a ground surface by pushing or pulling by a person performing the exercise routine, a front end which has wall portions (24, 26) for receiving the hands, knees or feet of the person, a rear end which has wall portions (28) for receiving the feet of the person, an intermediate region (20) which has an elevated portion (30) separating a first ramp portion (32) from a second ramp portion (34). Each of the first and second ramp portions has a forward facing ramp surface (36) and a rearward facing ramp surface (38). A first open recess (40, 42) is located between the wall portions at the front end and the forward facing ramp surfaces. A second open recess (44) is located between the wall portions at the rear end and the rearward facing ramp surfaces.

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Family ID:	81656118
Appl. No.:	18/552689
Filed (or PCT Filed):	April 01, 2021
PCT No.:	PCT/AU2021/050308
PCT Pub. No.:	WO2022/204748
PCT Pub. Date:	October 06, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240366988 A1	Nov. 07, 2024

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: A63B21/06 (20060101); A63B21/00 (20060101); A63B21/04 (20060101); A63B22/20 (20060101); A63B23/02 (20060101); A63B23/035 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC A63B21/0618 (20130101); A63B21/0004 (20130101); A63B21/0442 (20130101); A63B21/4015 (20151001); A63B21/4033 (20151001); A63B22/20 (20130101); A63B21/4017 (20151001); A63B23/02 (20130101); A63B23/035 (20130101); A63B2208/0219 (20130101); A63B2208/0295 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: A63B (21/0004); A63B (21/0442); A63B (21/0618); A63B (21/4015); A63B (21/4017); A63B (21/4033); A63B (22/20); A63B (23/035); A63B (2208/0219); A63B (2208/0295)

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present invention relates to an exercise sled and, in particular, to a sled for use in exercises

that develop the core strength of a person.

BACKGROUND

(2) Exercise sleds are known and have been used to build strength and stamina in athletes who participate in a range of sports, from sprinting to endurance and body contact sport.

(3) Normally, these known exercise sleds are designed and built with a specific exercise routine in mind, and so they enable an athlete to develop only certain muscles in a localized region of the body, normally the legs, arms or shoulders.

(4) It is, therefore, an object of the present invention to provide an exercise sled which may be utilized by a person to perform many different exercise routines that can stimulate the development of musculature in and around the core of the person's body, or at least provides a useful alternative to known exercise sleds.

SUMMARY OF INVENTION

(5) According to the present invention, there is provided an exercise sled for performing a core strengthening exercise routine, the exercise sled comprising a load bearing body having a bottom which is configured to slide on a ground surface by pushing or pulling by a person performing the exercise routine, a front end which has wall portions for receiving the hands, knees or feet of the person, a rear end which has wall portions for receiving the feet of the person, an intermediate region between the front and rear ends and which has an elevated portion separating a first ramp portion at a first side of the intermediate region from a second ramp portion at a second side of the intermediate region, wherein each of the first and second ramp portions has a forward facing ramp surface and a rearward facing ramp surface, and wherein a first open recess is located between the wall portions at the front end and the forward facing ramp surfaces, and a second open recess is located between the wall portions at the rear end and the rearward facing ramp surfaces.

(6) Preferably, the wall portions at the front end comprise a pair of wall portions.

(7) It is also preferred that the wall portions at the rear end comprise a single continuous wall.

(8) In a preferred form, the rearward facing ramp surface is steeper than the forward facing ramp surface.

(9) The intermediate region preferably has a rear surface which has two openings separated by a wall section, the openings having internal passageways which are interconnected.

(10) The front end preferably has a front surface which has two openings separated by a wall section, the openings having internal passageways which are interconnected.

(11) In another preferred form, the exercise sled further comprises an elastically stretchable line which forms a loop around the wall section of either the rear surface or the front surface after the elastically stretchable line is fed into one of the openings and then exits from the other opening, and the elastically stretchable line has free ends which are connected together around an external anchor point.

(12) The exercise sled may further comprise a pair of foot straps attached to the rearward facing ramp surfaces.

(13) The exercise sled may further comprise an opening in one or each of the rearward facing ramp surfaces for inserting into the or each opening a required weight to increase the load of the load bearing body.

(14) There has been thus outlined, rather broadly, the more important features of the invention in order that the detailed description thereof that follows may be better understood and put into practical effect, and in order that the present contribution to the art may be better appreciated.

(15) There are additional features of the invention that will be described hereinafter. As such, those skilled in the art will appreciate that the conception, upon which the disclosure is based, may be readily utilized as the basis for designing other structures, assemblies, process steps and system configurations for carrying out the object of the present invention. It is important, therefore, that the broad outline of the invention described above be regarded as including such equivalent features insofar as they do not depart from the spirit and scope of the present invention.

Description

SUMMARY OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a side perspective view of an exercise sled according to a preferred embodiment of the present invention.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a top view of the exercise sled shown in FIG. 1.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a rear perspective view of the exercise sled shown in FIG. 1.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a side elevation view of the exercise sled shown in FIG. 1.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a front view of the exercise sled shown in FIG. 1.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a rear view of the exercise sled shown in FIG. 1.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a view of a person kneeling behind, and bending over, the exercise sled of FIG. 1 with their forearms resting on the forward facing ramp surfaces and their hands gripping the front end of the exercise sled, in readiness to push the exercise sled forward in a first core strengthening movement of a first exercise routine.
- (8) FIG. 8 is a view of the person shown in FIG. 7 after having fully extended their body forward to push the exercise sled to an intermediate position, so that the person lies outstretched and face down, their torso elevated from the ground surface, and their arms outstretched with their hands still gripping the front end, in readiness to perform a second core strengthening movement of the first exercise routine in which the person uses their core strength to pull the exercise sled backwards to again assume the kneeling and bending position shown in FIG. 7.
- (9) FIG. 9 is a view of a person kneeling on, and bending towards, the front of the exercise sled of FIG. 1 with their feet on the rear end and their knees on the front end of the exercise sled, and with their hands to the side thereof, in readiness to stretch their body forward in a first core strengthening movement of a second exercise routine.
- (10) FIG. 10 is a view of the person shown in FIG. 9 after having fully extended their body away from the exercise sled to an intermediate position, so that the person lies outstretched and face down, their torso elevated from the ground surface, and their arms outstretched with their hands planted on the ground surface, in readiness to perform a second core strengthening movement of the second exercise routine in which the person uses their core strength to push the exercise sled forward to again assume the kneeling and bending position shown in FIG. 9.
- (11) FIG. 11 is a view of a person crouching on, and bending away from, the rear end of the exercise sled of FIG. 1 with their feet on the rear end of the exercise sled and their arms outstretched with their hands planted on the ground surface, in readiness to push the exercise sled rearwardly in a first core strengthening movement of a third exercise routine.
- (12) FIG. 12 is a view of the person shown in FIG. 11 after having fully extended their body rearwardly to push the exercise sled to an intermediate position, so that the person lies outstretched and face down, their torso elevated from the ground surface, and their arms outstretched with their hands still planted on the ground surface, in readiness to perform a second core strengthening movement of the third exercise routine in which the person uses their core strength to pull the exercise sled forward to again assume the crouching and bending position shown in FIG. 11.
- (13) FIG. 13 is a view of a person with the underside of their feet pressed against the rearward facing ramp surfaces of the exercise sled of FIG. 1, positioned with bent knees and upright torso elevated from the ground surface, and their arms outstretched with their hands planted on the ground surface, in readiness to push the exercise sled forward in a first core strengthening movement of a fourth exercise routine.
- (14) FIG. 14 is a view of the person shown in FIG. 13 after having fully extended their body forward to push the exercise sled to an intermediate position, so that the person lies outstretched and face up, their torso elevated from the ground surface, and their arms outstretched with their hands still planted on the ground surface, in readiness to perform a second core strengthening

movement of the fourth exercise routine in which the person uses their core strength to pull the exercise sled rearwardly to again assume the bent knees position shown in FIG. 13.

(15) FIG. 15 is a partial view of a person with the underside of their feet pressed against the forward facing ramp surfaces of the body of the exercise sled of FIG. 1, the person having the same starting body position as shown in FIG. 13, and an increased load is provided by connecting the body of the exercise sled to an elastically stretchable line which is anchored to an anchor point, in readiness to push the exercise sled forward in a first core strengthening movement of a fifth exercise routine.

(16) FIG. 16 is a partial view of the person shown in FIG. 15 after having fully extended their body forward to push the body of the exercise sled to a forward position, the person having the same body position as shown in FIG. 14, in readiness to release their extended leg pressure without lifting their feet from the forward facing ramp surfaces so that the stretched line can retract, bringing the body of the exercise sled sliding back towards the person so that the person can repeat the exercise routine.

(17) FIG. 17 is a partial view of a person with the underside of their feet pressed against the rearward facing ramp surfaces of the body of the exercise sled of FIG. 1, the person having the same starting body position as shown in FIG. 13, and an increased load is provided by connecting the body of the exercise sled to an elastically stretchable line which is anchored to an anchor point, in readiness to push the exercise sled forward in a first core strengthening movement of a sixth exercise routine.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

(18) The exercise sled 10 shown in FIGS. 1 to 17 comprises a load bearing body 12 with a bottom 14, a front end 16, a rear end 18 and an intermediate region 20 between the front end 16 and the rear end 18.

(19) The bottom 14 is configured to slide on a ground surface by pushing or pulling the exercise sled 10 by a person 22 performing an exercise routine. The surface of the bottom 14 has a level of frictional engagement or resistance with the ground surface which is suitable for the type of exercise routine to be performed. The load of the load bearing body 12 comprises the weight of the body 12 and the level of frictional engagement or resistance with the ground surface.

(20) The front end 16 has a pair of walls, each wall comprising wall portions 24, 26 for receiving the hands, knees or feet of the person 22. In an alternative embodiment, the front end has a single continuous wall and spaced-apart wall portions of that single continuous wall are adapted to be received by the hands, knees or feet of the person 22.

(21) The rear end 18 has a single continuous wall 28 and spaced-apart wall portions of that single continuous wall 28 are adapted to be received by the feet of the person 22. In an alternative embodiment, the rear end has a pair of walls, each wall comprising wall portions for receiving the feet of the person 22.

(22) The intermediate region 20 has an elevated portion 30 separating a first ramp portion 32 at a first side of the intermediate region from a second ramp portion 34 at a second side of the intermediate region.

(23) The ramp portions 32, 34 are identical in shape, size and orientation, and each ramp portion has a forward facing ramp surface 36 and a rearward facing ramp surface 38. In this embodiment, the rearward facing ramp surfaces 38 are steeper than the forward facing ramp surfaces 36, and so the rearward facing ramp surfaces 38 are ideally used as the surfaces against which the undersides of a person's feet can be pressed so as to push the exercise sled 10 in a core strengthening movement of an exercise routine. Although much less steep, the forward facing ramp surfaces 36 can also be used for this purpose, but in a manner which will be described later with reference to FIGS. 15 and 16. In this embodiment, each of the forward facing ramp surfaces 36 is at an angle of about 20° to the horizontal, but may be of any suitable angle for the type of exercise routine to be performed, such as between about 10° and about 35° to the horizontal. In this embodiment, each of

the rearward facing ramp surfaces **38** is at an angle of about 60° to the horizontal, but may be of any suitable angle for the type of exercise routine to be performed, such as between about 35° and about 90° to the horizontal.

(24) In this embodiment, the ramp portions **32, 34** are permanently secured to the rest of the body **12**, such as by being integrally formed during the forming of the entire body **12**, or by being affixed to the rest of the body by screws, adhesive or other permanent fastening means.

(25) In an alternative embodiment, the ramp portions **32, 34** are removably connected to the rest of the body **12** by any suitable clipping or sliding mechanisms, or by a combination of those mechanisms, or by any other suitable means that will allow ramp portions of a different size, shape and orientation to be used for the purpose of the type of exercise routine to be performed.

(26) The exercise sled **10** can be utilized by the person **22** to perform many different exercise routines that can stimulate the development of musculature in and around the core of the person's body.

(27) Each of the wall portions **24, 26** at the front end **16** are part of a respective first open recess **40, 42** which can also receive the hands, knees or feet of the person **22**. Each first open recess **40, 42** is located between its wall portion **24, 26** and its adjacent forward facing ramp surface **36**, and includes a floor **43**.

(28) The wall **28** at the rear end **18** is part of a second open recess **44** which can also receive the feet of the person **22**. The second open recess **44** is formed between the wall **28** and its adjacent rearward facing ramp surfaces **38**. The second open recess **44** includes a floor **46** for receiving the toes or heels of the feet.

(29) In this embodiment, the rearward facing ramp surfaces **38** do not have anything attached to them, but in an alternative embodiment, a pair of foot straps are attached to the rearward facing ramp surfaces for receiving therethrough the feet of the person **22**.

(30) In another embodiment, the rearward facing ramp surfaces **38** include an opening for inserting into the body **12** a required weight to increase the load.

(31) The elevated portion **30** of the intermediate region **20** slopes forwardly and downwardly from a high point **50** near the rear end **18** to the front end **16** through two consecutive angles, a first upper surface **52** of the elevated portion **30** having an angle which is not as steep as the angle of the second lower surface **54** of the elevated portion **30**. The elevated portion **30** also slopes rearwardly and downwardly from the high point **50** to form a rear surface **56**.

(32) In this embodiment, the rear surface **56** has two openings **58, 60** which are separated by a wall section **61**. The openings **58, 60** have internal passageways which are interconnected so that an elastically stretchable band, rope, tether or other such line can be fed into one of the openings and then exit the other opening, thereby forming a loop of the line around the wall section **61**, after which the free ends of the elastically stretchable line are tied or otherwise connected together around an external anchor point.

(33) Similar openings **62, 64**, with interconnected internal passageways and a wall section **65** for engaging a similar elastically stretchable line and for connecting that line to an external anchor point, are provided, in this embodiment, in a front surface **66** at the front end **16** of the body **12**.

(34) In other embodiments, the openings **58, 60** and the openings **62, 64** are absent, or only one pair of openings is present.

(35) The use of the exercise sled **10** will now be described with reference to FIGS. 7 to 17.

(36) As shown in FIG. 7, a person **22** is kneeling behind, and bending over, the exercise sled **10**.

Their forearms are resting on respective forward facing ramp surfaces **36** and their hands are gripping on respective wall portions **24, 26** at the front end **16** of the exercise sled **10**. The person is ready to push the exercise sled **10** forward in a first core strengthening movement of a first exercise routine.

(37) FIG. 8 shows the person **22** in FIG. 7 after having fully extended their body forward to push the exercise sled **10** to an intermediate position. The person lies outstretched and face down, their

torso elevated from the ground surface, and their arms are outstretched with their hands still gripping the wall portions **24, 26** of the exercise sled **10**. The person is ready to perform a second core strengthening movement of the first exercise routine in which the person, with their hands still gripping the wall portions **24, 26**, uses their core strength to pull the exercise sled backwards to again assume the kneeling and bending position shown in FIG. 7.

(38) As shown in FIG. 9, a person **22** is kneeling on, and bending towards, the front of the exercise sled **10**. The toes of their feet are in the open recess **44** and pressed against the wall **28** at the rear end **18** and their knees are resting in the open recesses **40, 42** at the front end **16** of the exercise sled **10**. Their arms are outstretched with their hands planted on the ground surface. The person is ready to stretch their body forward in a first core strengthening movement of a second exercise routine.

(39) FIG. 10 shows the person **22** in FIG. 9 after having fully extended their body away from the exercise sled **10** to an intermediate position. The person lies outstretched and face down, their torso elevated from the ground surface, and their arms are outstretched with their hands planted on the ground surface. The person is ready to perform a second core strengthening movement of the second exercise routine in which the person, with their knees still in the open recesses **40, 42** but now pressed against the wall portions **24, 26**, uses their core strength to push the exercise sled **10** forward to again assume the kneeling and bending position shown in FIG. 9.

(40) The second exercise routine described above with reference to FIGS. 9 and 10 results in the person **22** moving progressively forward with each repetition of the routine. However, a variation of the second exercise routine allows the person to remain in a stationary position by ensuring that their hands remain planted on the ground surface so that the lower body pushes the exercise sled **10** backward and forward, in a repetitive manner.

(41) As shown in FIG. 11, a person **22** is crouching on, and bending away from, the rear end **18** of the exercise sled **10**. The toes of their feet are in the open recess **44** and the soles of their feet are pressed against the rearward facing ramp surfaces **38** at the rear end **18** of the exercise sled **10**. Their arms are outstretched with their hands planted on the ground surface. The person is ready to push the exercise sled **10** rearwardly in a first core strengthening movement of a third exercise routine.

(42) FIG. 12 shows the person **22** in FIG. 11 after having fully extended their body rearwardly to push the exercise sled **10** to an intermediate position. The person lies outstretched and face down, their torso elevated from the ground surface, and their arms are outstretched with their hands still planted on the ground surface. The person is ready to perform a second core strengthening movement of the third exercise routine in which the person, with their toes still in the open recess **44** but now pressed against the wall **28**, uses their core strength to pull the exercise sled **10** forward to again assume the crouching and bending position shown in FIG. 11.

(43) As shown in FIG. 13, a person **22** has the heels of their feet in the open recess **44** and the soles of their feet are pressed against the rearward facing ramp surfaces **38** at the rear end **18** of the exercise sled **10**. The person is positioned with bent knees and upright torso elevated from the ground surface, and their arms are outstretched with their hands planted on the ground surface. The person is ready to push the exercise sled **10** forward in a first core strengthening movement of a fourth exercise routine.

(44) FIG. 14 shows the person **22** in FIG. 13 after having fully extended their body forward to push the exercise sled **10** to an intermediate position. The person lies outstretched and face up, their torso elevated from the ground surface, and their arms are outstretched with their hands still planted on the ground surface. The person is ready to perform a second core strengthening movement of the fourth exercise routine in which the person, with their heels still in the open recess **44** but now pressed against the wall **28**, uses their core strength to pull the exercise sled **10** rearwardly to again assume the bent knees position shown in FIG. 13.

(45) As shown in FIG. 15, a person **22** has the heels of their feet in the open recesses **40, 42** and the soles of their feet are pressed against the forward facing ramp surfaces **36** at the front end **16** of the

body **12** of the exercise sled **10**. Otherwise, the person may assume the same starting body position as shown in FIG. **13**, namely, the position with bent knees and upright torso elevated from the ground surface, and their arms are outstretched with their hands planted on the ground surface, or may assume some other similar starting body position.

(46) An elastically stretchable line **70** is looped through the openings **62, 64** and around the wall section **61** in the front surface **66** of the body **12** and the free ends of the line **70** are connected together around an external anchor point **72**. An increased load is provided by so connecting the body **12** of the exercise sled **10** to the elastically stretchable line **70** which is anchored at its opposite end to the anchor point **72**. The person **22** is ready to push the body of the exercise sled **10** forward, and so elastically stretch the line **70**, in a first core strengthening movement of a fifth exercise routine.

(47) FIG. **16** shows the person **22** in FIG. **15** after having fully extended their body forward to push the body **12** of the exercise sled **10** to a forward position. The person can release their extended leg pressure without lifting their feet from the forward facing ramp surfaces **36**, which will allow the stretched line **70** to retract, bringing the body of the exercise sled **10** sliding back towards the person so that the person can again assume the same, or a similar, starting body position for repeating the exercise routine.

(48) As shown in FIG. **17**, a person **22** has the heels of their feet pressed against the rearward facing ramp surfaces **38** at the rear end **18** of the body **12** of the exercise sled **10**. Otherwise, the person may assume the same starting body position as shown in FIG. **13**, namely, the position with bent knees and upright torso elevated from the ground surface, and their arms are outstretched with their hands planted on the ground surface, or may assume some other similar starting body position.

(49) An elastically stretchable line **70** is looped through the openings **58, 60** and around the wall section **65** in the rear surface **56** of the body **12** and the free ends of the line **70** are connected together around an external anchor point **72** so as to increase the load. The person **22** is ready to push the body of the exercise sled **10** forward, and so elastically stretch the line **70**, in a first core strengthening movement of a sixth exercise routine.

(50) When the body **12** of the exercise sled **10** has been pushed to a forward position, the person can release their extended leg pressure without lifting their feet from the rearward facing ramp surfaces **38**, which will allow the stretched line **70** to retract, bringing the body of the exercise sled **10** sliding back towards the person so that the person can again assume the same, or a similar, starting body position for repeating the exercise routine.

(51) It will also be readily apparent to persons skilled in the art that various modifications may be made in details of the design and construction of the above embodiment of the exercise sled without departing from the scope or ambit of the present invention.

(52) For example, the bottom **14** of the sled may have the added capability of temporarily engaging a plurality of wheels, such as omnidirectional wheels, having the desired level of frictional resistance, when it is not desired to exercise by sliding the bottom of the exercise sled on a ground surface.

(53) The reference in this specification to any prior publication (or information derived from it), or to any matter which is known, is not, and should not be taken as an acknowledgement or admission or any form of suggestion that that prior publication (or information derived from it) or known matter forms part of the common general knowledge in the field of endeavour to which this specification relates before the filing date of this patent application.

Claims

1. An exercise sled for performing a core strengthening exercise routine, the exercise sled comprising a load bearing body having a bottom which is configured to slide on a ground surface

by pushing or pulling by a person performing the exercise routine, a front end which has wall portions configured for receiving the hands, knees or feet of the person, a rear end which has wall portions configured for receiving the feet of the person, an intermediate region between the front and rear ends and which has an elevated portion separating a first ramp portion at a first side of the intermediate region from a second ramp portion at a second side of the intermediate region, wherein each of the first and second ramp portions has a forward facing ramp surface and a rearward facing ramp surface, and wherein a first open recess is located between the wall portions at the front end and the forward facing ramp surfaces, and a second open recess is located between the wall portions at the rear end and the rearward facing ramp surfaces.

2. The exercise sled of claim 1, wherein the wall portions at the front end comprise a pair of wall portions.

3. The exercise sled of claim 1, wherein the wall portions at the rear end comprise a single continuous wall.

4. The exercise sled of claim 1 wherein the rearward facing ramp surface is steeper than the forward facing ramp surface.

5. The exercise sled of claim 1 wherein the intermediate region has a rear surface which has two openings separated by a wall section, the openings having internal passage ways which are interconnected.

6. The exercise sled of claim 5 further comprising an elastically stretchable line which forms a loop around the wall section of the rear surface of the intermediate region after the elastically stretchable line is fed into one of the openings and then exits from the other opening, and the elastically stretchable line has free ends which are connected together around an external anchor point.

7. The exercise sled of claim 1 wherein the front end has a front surface which has two openings separated by a wall section, the openings having internal passageways which are interconnected.

8. The exercise sled of claim 7 further comprising an elastically stretchable line which forms a loop around the wall section of the front surface of the front end after the elastically stretchable line is fed into one of the openings and then exits from the other opening, and the elastically stretchable line has free ends which are connected together around an external anchor point.

9. The exercise sled of claim 1 further comprising a pair of foot straps attached to the rearward facing ramp surfaces.

10. The exercise sled of claim 1 further comprising an opening in one or each of the rearward facing ramp surfaces for inserting into the or each opening a required weight to increase the load of the load bearing body.
